



Luxury Hospitality & Brand Management

Assignment 1 · Concepts, Definitions & Approaches · Summary Sheet · Fall 2026

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1 What Is Luxury?

From the Latin “*luxus*” (excess, indulgence): goods and services that go beyond necessity and offer pleasure, prestige, and comfort. Six features of luxury (Dubois, Laurent & Czellar, 2001):

01

Excellent quality

02

Very high price

03

Scarcity & uniqueness

04

Aesthetics & senses

05

Heritage & history

06

Superfluous (non-essential)

2 Key Definitions

Luxury Hospitality

Accommodation, F&B and leisure at the highest level of quality and personal service: prime location, exclusive design, high staff-to-guest ratio, privacy, memorable experiences.

Brand Management

Designing and running marketing programs to build, measure and manage brand equity (Keller, 2013): awareness, perceived quality, associations, loyalty (Aaker, 1991).

Brand

“A name, term, sign, symbol, or design... intended to identify the goods or services of one seller and differentiate them from competitors” (Kotler & Keller, 2016).

Luxury Brand Management

Managing luxury brands so they keep exclusivity, desirability and heritage, never appearing too available (Kapferer & Bastien, 2012).

The Ritz-Carlton Four Seasons Raffles Six Senses St. Regis

3 Approaches to Understanding Luxury

- **Economic:** demand rises faster than income; “Veblen goods” gain appeal as price rises (Veblen, 1899).
- **Consumer perception:** luxury is what customers perceive, for social and personal reasons (Vigneron & Johnson, 2004).
- **Product / quality:** superior materials, craftsmanship, design and service standards.
- **Experiential:** selling unique, emotional, memorable moments (Pine & Gilmore, 1998).

4 Approaches to Managing Luxury Brands

- **Luxury strategy:** high prices, controlled distribution, limited availability (Kapferer & Bastien, 2012).
- **Brand equity:** from awareness to loyalty and resonance (Keller, 2013).
- **Heritage & storytelling:** history and origin, e.g., The Savoy, Raffles.
- **Service excellence:** “Ladies and Gentlemen serving Ladies and Gentlemen” (Ritz-Carlton).
- **Brand portfolio:** Marriott (Ritz-Carlton, St. Regis, JW) · Accor (Raffles, Fairmont, Sofitel).

Key takeaway: Luxury hospitality combines quality, exclusivity and personal service to create memorable experiences, while brand management builds and protects the value of the brand in guests' minds. This matters more and more in Saudi Arabia as Vision 2030 projects such as the Red Sea and ALUla grow the luxury market.